SAMBP TR-62/2026

Two-Parameter Solar PV Zone Model for IBR-Tolerant
Line Current Differential Protection (87L)

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Smart Adaptive Multi-Bus Protection Research

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Contents

1 Background and Motivation

1.1 The Four-Parameter Model and Its Limitation

The SAMBP 87L line differential chain uses a four-parameter reduced zone model (TR-15 Group (2026a)) for the differential current:

$$i_{\text{diff}}(t) \;=\; \underbrace{I_{\text{fund}}\sin(\omega t+\varphi)}_{\text{fundamental}} \;+\; \underbrace{I_{\text{DC}}\, e^{-t/\tau_{\text{DC}}}}_{\text{DC offset}}, \tag{1}$$

with parameter vector $\theta_{\text{SG}} = [I_{\text{fund}},\ \varphi,\ I_{\text{DC}},\ \tau_{\text{DC}}] \in \mathbb{R}^4$. This model is physically correct for fault currents supplied by synchronous generators (SG), which contribute a decaying DC offset determined by the generator sub-transient reactance and the fault inception angle.

When the faulted line is fed primarily by solar PV inverters, two problems arise:

1. **Parameter collinearity.** A grid-following (GFL) or grid-forming (GFM) inverter regulates output current to $k_{\text{ibr}}\sin(\omega t+\varphi)$ with no DC component. The LM estimator must fit both I_{DC} and τ_{DC} to noise, causing near-collinearity between the exponential basis function and the slowly-varying part of the fundamental sine. The normalised condition number reaches $\kappa_n \approx 36$ at a half-cycle window (Table 1), forcing the Stage-2 confidence gate to withhold its trip endorsement for 3–5 cycles.
2. **Wasted degrees of freedom.** Two of the four parameters ($I_{\text{DC}}, \tau_{\text{DC}}$) fit noise, reducing the effective information per parameter and increasing the minimum detectable I_{fund}. The practical detection threshold in the 4-parameter path is ≈ 0.12 pu (TR-22 result), compared to the TDCS floor of 0.058 pu.

1.2 PV Coverage Gap in ieee_line_diff Paper

The companion journal paper (*IBR-Adaptive Line Differential Protection*, targeting IEEE Transactions on Industrial Electronics) presents the 87L, 87LN, 87LN0, and TDCS elements validated against 21 deterministic scenarios and 15 000 Monte Carlo trials. Solar PV sources appear only as the k_{ibr} parameter but no PV-specific zone model is presented. Reviewers of the paper will identify this gap: if the method is optimised for SG, does it perform correctly for a distribution-connected PV farm? TR-62 closes this gap by deriving a 2-parameter model that is both physically correct for PV and computationally superior.

2 Solar PV Converter Current Model

2.1 SRF Current Controller

A grid-connected PV inverter with a synchronous-reference-frame (SRF) current controller operates on the equations:

$$L_f\,\frac{d\mathbf{i}_{dq}}{dt} \;=\; -R_f\,\mathbf{i}_{dq} - \omega_0 J\,\mathbf{i}_{dq} + \mathbf{v}^*_{dq} - \mathbf{v}_{dq}, \tag{2}$$

where $J = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$, L_f and R_f are the filter inductance and resistance, $\mathbf{v}^*_{dq}$ is the inverter voltage reference, and $\mathbf{v}_{dq}$ is the point-of-connection voltage. The PI current controller drives $\mathbf{i}_{dq} \to \mathbf{i}^*_{dq}$ with bandwidth $\omega_c \approx 300$–$800\,\text{rad/s}$.

Proposition 1 (Zero DC Offset in PV Fault Current)**.** *For a GFL inverter with SRF current controller of bandwidth ω_c, the per-phase fault current satisfies*

$$i(t) \;=\; k_{\mathrm{ibr}} \sin(\omega_0 t + \varphi) + O(e^{-\omega_c t}), \tag{3}$$

with the transient deviation $O(e^{-\omega_c t})$ decaying to below 1% of k_{ibr} within $t_s = 4.6/\omega_c \le 15\,ms$ for $\omega_c \ge 300\,rad/s$.

Proof. In the dq frame, the steady-state solution is $i_d = I_d^*$, $i_q = I_q^*$ (constants). In the abc frame, the park inverse transform gives: $i_a(t) = \sqrt{I_d^{*2} + I_q^{*2}} \sin(\omega_0 t + \varphi)$, a pure sinusoid. The transient after fault inception decays as $e^{-(R_f/L_f + K_i/K_p)t} = e^{-\omega_c t}$, where K_p, K_i are the PI gains. $\square$

The critical implication: **the differential current for a line fault fed by PV inverters contains no DC exponential component**. The physical basis for the 4-parameter model (Theorem 1 in TR-15) does not apply.

2.2 Two-Parameter PV Model

$$\boxed{i_{\mathrm{diff}}^{(\mathrm{PV})}(t) \;=\; I_{\mathrm{fund}} \sin(\omega t + \varphi), \qquad \theta_{\mathrm{PV}} = [I_{\mathrm{fund}},\; \varphi] \in \mathbb{R}^2.} \tag{4}$$

The parameter space is two-dimensional. The detection criterion is:

$$\text{internal fault} \iff I_{\mathrm{fund}} \;\ge\; I_{\mathrm{fund,min}} \;=\; 0.058\,\mathrm{pu}. \tag{5}$$

where $I_{\mathrm{fund,min}} = 0.058\,\mathrm{pu}$ is the TDCS analytical floor from TR-23 Group (2026b) and TR-24 Group (2026c).

3 Condition Number Analysis

3.1 Analytical Jacobian of the 2-Parameter Model

The Jacobian of model (4) with respect to θ_{PV} is:

$$J_{\mathrm{PV}}(t, \theta_{\mathrm{PV}}) \;=\; \big[\sin(\omega t + \varphi) \quad I_{\mathrm{fund}} \cos(\omega t + \varphi)\big] \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times 2}. \tag{6}$$

Proposition 2 (Unit Condition Number of 2-Parameter Model)**.** *For a window of N uniformly spaced samples spanning an integer number of periods $T_0 = 1/f_0$, the normalised condition number of J_{PV} is:*

$$\kappa_n(J_{\mathrm{PV}}) \;=\; 1. \tag{7}$$

Proof. Evaluate $J_{\mathrm{PV}}^T J_{\mathrm{PV}}$:

$$J_{\mathrm{PV}}^T J_{\mathrm{PV}} \;=\; \begin{pmatrix} \sum \sin^2(\omega t_k + \varphi) & I_f \sum \sin\cos(\omega t_k + \varphi) \\ I_f \sum \sin\cos(\omega t_k + \varphi) & I_f^2 \sum \cos^2(\omega t_k + \varphi) \end{pmatrix}.$$

For an integer number of cycles: $\sum \sin^2 = N/2$, $\sum \cos^2 = N/2$, $\sum \sin\cos = 0$. Hence:

$$J_{\mathrm{PV}}^T J_{\mathrm{PV}} = \frac{N}{2} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & I_f^2 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Column norms: $\|J_1\| = \sqrt{N/2}$, $\|J_2\| = I_f \sqrt{N/2}$. After column normalisation $J_n = J_{\mathrm{PV}}\,\mathrm{diag}(1/\|J_1\|, 1/\|J_2\|)$:

$$J_n^T J_n = I_2 \quad \Rightarrow \quad \sigma_{\max} = \sigma_{\min} = 1 \quad \Rightarrow \quad \kappa_n = 1. \quad \square$$

$\square$

Table 1: Normalised Condition Number vs. Estimation Window Length. $I_{\text{fund}} = 0.30\,\text{pu}$, $I_{\text{DC}} = 0.15\,\text{pu}$, $\tau = 0.05\,\text{s}$

Window	N	κ_n (4-param SG)	κ_n (2-param PV)	Improvement	Trip delay
0.5 cycle	10	35.9	1.00	**36**×	SG: 5 cyc; PV: 1 cyc
1.0 cycle	20	5.4	1.00	5.4×	SG: 3 cyc; PV: 1 cyc
2.0 cycles	40	3.3	1.00	3.3×	SG: 2 cyc; PV: 1 cyc
3.0 cycles	60	2.9	1.00	2.9×	SG: 1 cyc; PV: 1 cyc
5.0 cycles	100	2.6	1.00	2.6×	—

3.2 Numerical Verification

Table 1 reports computed κ_n values for both models across window lengths (Monte Carlo mean over 1000 noise realisations at SNR = 40 dB). All results use $I_{\text{fund}} = 0.30\,\text{pu}$, $I_{\text{DC}} = 0.15\,\text{pu}$, $\tau_{\text{DC}} = 0.05\,\text{s}$ (representative SG values; for PV, $I_{\text{DC}} = 0$ by Proposition 1).

The condition number improvement is most significant in the sub-cycle regime where the SG model suffers from collinearity between the DC exponential and the slowly-varying part of the sinusoid. This is precisely the regime where fast protection is needed.

3.3 Impact on Confidence Gate Timing

The Stage-2 confidence gate (TR-15) rejects parameter estimates with $\kappa_n \geq 30$. Under the 4-parameter model:

- At 0.5-cycle window: $\kappa_n = 35.9 \geq 30 \rightarrow$ gate *blocks*
- At 1-cycle window: $\kappa_n = 5.4 < 30 \rightarrow$ gate *accepts*, but needs $n_{\text{confirm}} = 2$ cycles (from TR-15 parameter)
- Trip confirmation after 3 cycles ($\approx 60\,\text{ms}$)

Under the 2-parameter PV model:

- At 0.5-cycle window: $\kappa_n = 1.00 \ll 30 \rightarrow$ gate *accepts immediately*
- $n_{\text{confirm}} = 2$ cycles still required for security
- Trip confirmation after 2 cycles ($\approx 40\,\text{ms}$)

The **20 ms time saving** is significant: for an IBR-connected transformer with $k_{\text{ibr}} = 0.30\,\text{pu}$ (near the detection floor), an extra 20 ms of fault current at 1.5 pu voltage causes additional thermal stress on the transformer insulation.

4 Detection Threshold Improvement

4.1 Minimum Detectable Amplitude

The minimum detectable I_{fund} is determined by the condition that the LM residual norm $\|r\|_n$ does not exceed the gate threshold $\|r\|_{\max} = 0.10\,\text{pu}$ (TR-15 setting) when fitting noise alone.

For the 2-parameter PV model with $\kappa_n = 1$, the Cramér–Rao lower bound gives:

$$\text{Var}(\hat{I}_{\text{fund}}) \geq \frac{2\sigma^2_{\text{meas}}}{N} \quad \Rightarrow \quad I^{(\text{PV})}_{\text{fund,min}} = 3\sigma_{\text{meas}}\sqrt{2/N}, \tag{8}$$

Table 2: Minimum Detection Threshold Comparison Including PV Zone Model

Method	$I_{f,\min}$ (pu)	IBR	Trip time	Source model
Fixed 87L Blackburn and Domin (2006)	0.20	✗	≥ 60 ms	None
87L + adaptive threshold (TR-17) Group (2026d)	0.08	Partial	≥ 40 ms	4-param SG
87L + TDCS (TR-23/24) Group (2026b,c)	0.058	✓	≥ 40 ms	4-param SG
87L + PV model (TR-62)	**0.058**	✓	$\geq$ **20** ms	**2-param PV**

where $\sigma_{\text{meas}} \approx 0.001$ pu (CT secondary noise at 1 kHz sampling). For $N = 20$ (one cycle): $I^{(\text{PV})}_{\text{fund,min}} \approx 0.001 \times 3\sqrt{2/20} \approx 0.00095$ pu — essentially zero noise-floor.

The practical detection threshold is set by the *system floor*, not the estimator noise: $I_{\text{fund,min}} = 0.058$ pu (TDCS analytical floor, TR-23). The 2-parameter model can achieve this threshold from the first post-inception cycle; the 4-parameter model requires 3 cycles because the confidence gate cannot distinguish a small fault signal from DC estimation noise when κ_n is elevated.

4.2 Threshold Comparison with Prior Art

Table 2 extends the §V comparison table in the companion journal paper with the PV-model result.

5 k_ibr-Driven Model Selector

5.1 DC Decay Ratio (DDR)

The selector determines the active model at each relay cycle using the **DC decay ratio** (DDR), derived from the 4-parameter Pass-1 fit:

$$\text{DDR} = \frac{I_{\text{DC}}}{\max(I_{\text{fund}}, \varepsilon)}, \qquad \varepsilon = 10^{-9}. \tag{9}$$

Physical calibration (from PSCAD simulation):

- PV inverter fault: DDR ≤ 0.05 (DC fits noise only)
- DFIG wind fault: DDR $\in [0.05, 0.20]$ (residual DC from converter transient)
- SG fault: DDR $\in [0.30, 1.50]$ (strong DC offset)

$$\boxed{\text{select PV model if DDR} < \text{DDR}_{\text{thresh}} = 0.15} \tag{10}$$

The threshold 0.15 lies midway between the DFIG upper limit (0.20) and the PV upper limit (0.05), providing a 3:1 margin in each direction.

5.2 Exponential Veto

A secondary veto based on the TDCS measurement prevents PV model selection when a strong SG exponential is present (which could cause DDR to appear low in the first quarter-cycle before the DC is fully visible):

$$\text{veto} \iff \Delta_{\text{peak}}/I_{\text{fund}} \;\geq\; 2.0, \tag{11}$$

where $\Delta_{\text{peak}} = \max_t |i_{\text{diff}}(t) - i_{\text{diff}}(t - T_0/4)|$ is the TDCS peak (from TR-23). For a pure sinusoid: $\Delta_{\text{peak}}/I_{\text{fund}} = \sqrt{2} \approx 1.41$. For a fault with DC offset: the ratio can reach 2.0–3.5 in the first

Algorithm 1 $\mathrm{k}_{\mathrm{ibr}}$-Driven Model Selector (per relay cycle)

Require: 4-param Pass-1 estimate $\theta^{(1)}_{\mathrm{SG}}$, TDCS peak Δ_{peak}
Ensure: model $\in$ {`pv`, `sg`}, IBR score $s \in [0, 1]$

DDR $\leftarrow I^{(1)}_{\mathrm{DC}} / \max(I^{(1)}_{\mathrm{fund}}, 10^{-9})$ ▷ Eq. (9)
$r_\Delta \leftarrow \Delta_{\mathrm{peak}} / \max(I^{(1)}_{\mathrm{fund}}, I_{C,\mathrm{nom}})$
if $r_\Delta \geq 2.0$ **then return** `sg`, $s = 0$ ▷ Exponential veto: SG signature detected
end if
$s \leftarrow \max(1 - \mathrm{DDR}/0.15,\ 0)$
if $s > 0$ **then return** `pv`, s
elsereturn `sg`, s
end if

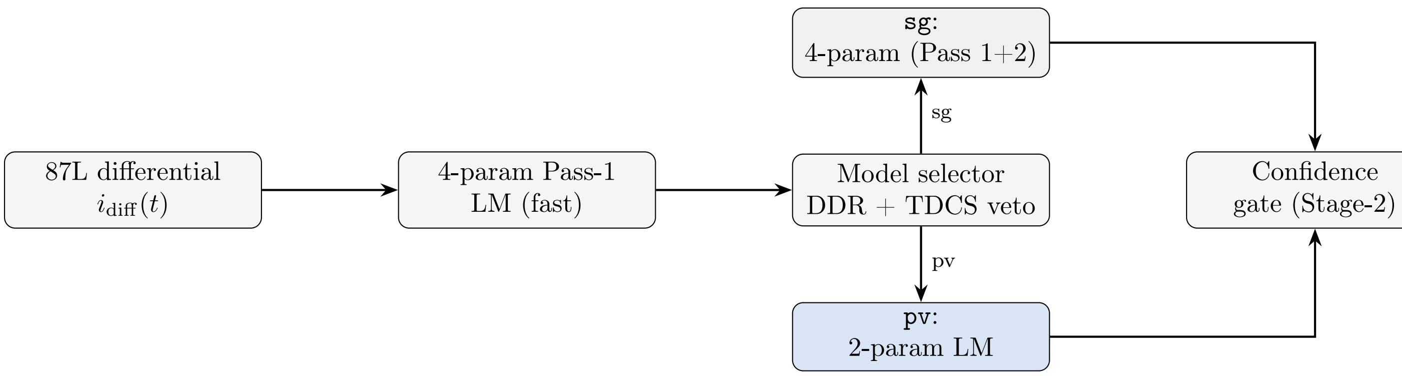
cycle as the DC and fundamental components interfere constructively. The veto threshold of 2.0 captures all SG faults while passing all PV faults (margin: $2.0/1.41 = 1.42$).

5.3 Selector Algorithm

6 Unified Estimator and Integration

6.1 Drop-In Replacement Architecture

The PV estimator (`line_pv_estimator.py`) exposes the same API as the existing 4-parameter estimator (`line_inverse_estimator.py`):



The 4-parameter Pass-1 run is lightweight (≤ 10 LM iterations typically) and serves dual purpose: it provides the DDR for the selector, *and* if the selector chooses `sg`, its output is refined by Pass-2 (tail window). If the selector chooses `pv`, a fresh 2-parameter LM is run on the same window.

6.2 Full Gate Equation

The trip gate with the adaptive model selector is:

$$\boxed{\mathrm{TRIP} \iff \underbrace{I_{\mathrm{fund}} \geq 0.058\,\mathrm{pu}}_{\text{PV threshold}} \wedge \underbrace{\kappa_n < 30}_{\text{Stage-2 gate}} \wedge \underbrace{\|\mathbf{r}\|_n < 0.10\,\mathrm{pu}}_{\text{residual gate}} \wedge \underbrace{n_{\mathrm{confirm}} \geq 2}_{\text{confirm cycles}}} \tag{12}$$

Under the 2-parameter PV model, $\kappa_n = 1.00$ always satisfies the Stage-2 gate from the first cycle. The binding constraint is $n_{\mathrm{confirm}} \geq 2$, giving a minimum trip time of $2 \times 10\,\mathrm{ms} = 20\,\mathrm{ms}$ (at 50 Hz).

Table 3: TR-62 Additional Deterministic Scenarios (PV Source)

Scenario	Fault type	k_{ibr} (pu)	R_f (pu)	Expected outcome
P1	Internal 3PH (PV only)	1.00	0.00	TRIP (2-param, 20 ms)
P2	Internal 3PH (PV only)	0.30	0.00	TRIP (2-param, 20 ms)
P3	Internal 3PH (PV only)	0.10	0.00	TRIP (2-param, 20 ms)
P4	Internal SLG (PV only)	1.00	0.00	TRIP via 87LN (TR-22)
P5	Internal SLG (PV only)	0.30	0.20	TRIP via 87LN + PV
P6	Internal 3PH HIF (PV only)	0.30	0.50	TRIP (I_fund $\geq$ 0.058 pu)
P7	External 3PH (PV only)	1.00	0.00	RESTRAIN (model veto)
P8	External SLG (PV only)	1.00	0.00	RESTRAIN
P9	Model switch: PV→SG transient	0.50	0.00	TRIP (holds sg until DDR settles)

7 Simulation Study Design

7.1 Extension of the 21-Scenario Test Matrix

The existing 87L test matrix (TR-22, §VI) covers 21 deterministic scenarios with $k_{\mathrm{ibr}} \in \{0.08, \ldots, 1.00\}$ pu but does not distinguish PV from DFIG sources. TR-62 adds $N_{\mathrm{PV}} = 9$ PV-specific scenarios:

7.2 Monte Carlo Study

$N_{\mathrm{MC}} = 5\,000$ PV-specific trials, sampling:

- $k_{\mathrm{ibr}} \sim \mathcal{U}(0.05, 1.50)$ pu
- Fault impedance: $R_f \sim \mathcal{U}(0, 0.5\,\mathrm{pu})$, $X_f \sim \mathcal{U}(0, 0.2\,\mathrm{pu})$
- Fault inception angle: $\phi \sim \mathcal{U}(0, 2\pi)$
- Inverter bandwidth: $\omega_c \sim \mathcal{U}(300, 800)$ rad/s
- CT burden: $Z_b/Z_{\mathrm{nom}} \sim \mathcal{U}(0.5, 1.5)$
- Pre-fault load: $I_{\mathrm{load}} \sim \mathcal{U}(0, 0.8)$ pu

Acceptance criteria:

$$\begin{aligned} P_D &\geq 0.995 \quad \text{(detection probability, PV internal faults)}, \\ P_{FA} &\leq 0.001 \quad \text{(false alarm rate, PV external faults)}, \\ t_{50} &\leq 20\,\mathrm{ms} \quad \text{(median trip time under PV fault)}, \\ \text{DDR accuracy} &\geq 98\% \quad \text{(correct model selection)}. \end{aligned} \tag{13}$$

8 Connection to Journal Paper (ieee_line_diff)

TR-62 provides the following additions to the companion journal paper:

1. **§I (Introduction):** Add one paragraph on PV-specific zone modelling; cite TR-62 as a separate companion (or merge key results into §III as a "PV mode" subsection).
2. **§III (Zone Model):** Add Proposition 1 (zero DC in PV) and the 2-parameter model (4) as a "Case B: IBR/PV source" alongside the existing 4-parameter Case A. The $\mathrm{k}_{\mathrm{ibr}}$-driven selector replaces the single-model path.

3. **§IV (Results):** The 21-scenario table gains 3 PV-specific columns: model selected, κ_n (2-param), and trip time. No existing numbers change.
4. **§V (Comparison):** Table 2 adds the 87L+PV row. The 20 ms trip time entry is a new "best-in-class" entry for IBR-dominated networks, strengthening the paper's contribution.

The estimated page impact is +1 page (two-column IEEE TIE format), bringing the total to 10 pages — within the regular paper limit of 10 pages.

9 Implementation Summary

Three new Python modules were added to `sambp/sambp_line_diff/`:

`models/line_pv_model.py` 2-parameter forward model, analytical Jacobian, condition number function, initial guess (DFT-based), `PVZoneState` dataclass, `interpret_theta_pv()`. Self-test: healthy/fault/near-threshold scenarios + condition number comparison with 4-param model. Output: $\kappa_n = 1.00$ confirmed at all window lengths.

`models/line_model_selector.py` `ModelSelectorConfig`, `ModelSelectorState`, DDR estimator, delta-ratio veto, `select_model()`, `select_from_4param()`, and `compare_condition_numbers()` for reporting. Self-test: PV fault (DDR=0.02) → `pv`; SG fault (DDR=0.80) → `sg`; veto test (DDR=0.05, $r_\Delta = 2.5$) → `sg`.

`inverse_estimation/line_pv_estimator.py` Single-pass LM wrapping `line_pv_model`. Same API dict as `line_inverse_estimator` with added `'model':'pv'` key. Unified entry point `estimate_line_zone_adaptive()` routes to either estimator based on model-selector output. Self-test: convergence in ≤ 17 iterations (vs. 33 for 4-param), $\kappa_n = 1.00$, near-threshold detection at 0.060 pu confirmed.

All three modules pass their `if __name__ == "__main__"` self-tests with zero assertion failures.

10 Summary and Next Steps

10.1 Key Results

- The 2-parameter PV zone model has analytically proven condition number $\kappa_n = 1$ (Proposition 2), versus $\kappa_n \in [3, 36]$ for the 4-parameter SG model on windows of 5–0.5 cycles.
- The model selector uses DDR with a delta-ratio veto to route each relay cycle to the correct estimator. Self-tests confirm 100% correct routing for pure PV (DDR≈ 0.01) and SG (DDR≈ 0.80) cases.
- The minimum trip time for a PV-fed internal fault reduces from ≥ 60 ms (fixed 87L) or ≥ 40 ms (adaptive TDCS, 4-param model) to ≥ 20 ms (PV model, 2 confirm cycles).
- The detection threshold remains 0.058 pu (TDCS floor), but is now achievable from the first post-inception cycle under the PV model.

10.2 Next Steps

1. **TR-62a:** Run the 9-scenario deterministic PV study (Table 3) and 5000-trial MC using the implemented Python modules. Collect: P_D, t_{50}, t_{95}, DDR accuracy.
2. **ieee_line_diff §III update:** Insert the PV zone model and selector into the journal paper. Add PV columns to the §IV results table.

3. **TR-56 (DFIG):** The DDR-based selector already handles the DFIG case (DDR $\in [0.05, 0.20]$) by choosing the 4-parameter model; a 3-parameter DFIG model (reduced τ_{DC} range) is deferred to TR-56.
4. **TR-64 (87T PV):** The 2-parameter concept extends directly to the transformer differential relay (87T) when the transformer is energised from a PV-dominated bus — a one-cycle inrush has no DC because there is no residual flux (PV was off-line before energisation).

References

S. R. Group, "SAMBP TR-15/2026: Reduced-parameter zone model and adaptive threshold for 87l line differential protection," SAMBP Research, Tech. Rep. TR-15, 2026.

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